1. Purpose

This policy describes when Alderpoint Health Plan covers calcitonin gene-related peptide (CGRP) antagonists for the prevention of migraine.

2. Definitions

Migraine day: a calendar day with a headache that meets criteria for migraine or is treated with a migraine-specific acute medication.

Preferred oral preventive medication: topiramate, propranolol, metoprolol, amitriptyline, or divalproex sodium.

3. Coverage criteria

3.1 Initial authorization. A CGRP antagonist is medically necessary when all of the following are documented:

(a) The member has a diagnosis of migraine with at least 4 migraine days per month in each of the 3 months before the request.

(b) The member completed a trial of at least 8 weeks of at least one preferred oral preventive medication.

(c) The trial in (b) was ineffective or was discontinued because of intolerable adverse effects.

(d) The medication is prescribed by, or in consultation with, a neurologist or headache specialist.

3.2 Exception. A trial under 3.1(b) is not required when every preferred oral preventive medication is contraindicated for the member and each contraindication is documented.

3.3 Renewal. Continued coverage requires documentation of a reduction in monthly migraine days compared with baseline.

4. Documentation

Acceptable documentation includes chart notes, a medication history with start and stop dates, and a headache diary or its summary in a chart note.

5. Authorization period

Initial authorization is for 12 months.

6. Not covered

Use together with another CGRP antagonist for prevention. Use for acute treatment is addressed in a separate policy.